

Amelie Tolvin

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto | Toronto, Canada

PhD, Political Science

2028 (*exp.*)

Subfields: Comparative Politics, International Relations

Dissertation: Explaining Variation in Violence Against Civilians: Russian Military Unit Dynamics in Occupied Ukraine

Committee: Lucan Way (Chair), Olga Chyzh, Seva Gunitsky

University of Toronto | Toronto, Canada

MA, European and Russian Affairs

2022

Major Research Paper: "Use Your Weapons": Protest Repression in Lukashenka's Belarus"

University of British Columbia | Vancouver, Canada

BA, Political Science and Russian

2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political violence, violence against civilians, military conduct, state repression, authoritarianism.

PUBLISHED WORKS

Peer Reviewed

Amelie Tolvin. 2025. "[Repression and Protest in Belarus: A Retrospective Review of State Strategies in 2020.](#)"

Belarus Analytical Digest (2).

Katri Pynnöniemi and Amelie Tolvin. 2025. "[Reconstructing Kremlin strategic deception: the logic of disinformation narratives during the first phase of the full-scale invasion of Ukraine.](#)" *The Journal of Slavic Military Studies* 38 (3).

Lucan Way and Amelie Tolvin. 2025. "[Multiparty Elections in Autocracies.](#)" In *The Oxford Handbook of Authoritarian Politics*, edited by Anne Wolf. Oxford University Press.

Lucan Way and Amelie Tolvin. 2023. "[Why the 2020 Belarusian Protests Failed to Oust Lukashenka.](#)" *Nationalities Papers* 51 (4).

Other Publications

Amelie Tolvin. 2025. "Why Don't Russian Soldiers Revolt?" *Foreign Policy*. April 9.

Amelie Tolvin, Margarita Zavadskaya, and Boris Grozovsky. 2025. "За деньги или за идею? О готовности российских мужчин воевать [For money or for ideology? On the readiness of Russian men to fight]." *The Moscow Times*. January 28.

"Post-Conflict Democratization: A Review." *Research report prepared for the National Democratic Institute (Washington, DC) with the Comparative Autocracy Research Network*. 2024.

APPOINTMENTS AND EXPERIENCE

University of Helsinki | Helsinki, Finland

Researcher, Mannerheim Professorship of Russian Security Studies Working Group

2024 – Present

University of Toronto | Toronto, ON

Research Assistant, Professor Lucan Way

2021 – Present

Research Assistant, Professor Edward Schatz

2023

ACADEMIC CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

Panel Presentations and Invited Talks

Repression and Protest in Belarus: A Retrospective on State Strategies in 2020 (*Centre for New Ideas June 2025*)

"Use Your Weapons": Protest Repression in Lukashenka's Belarus (*University of Helsinki, June 2022*)

"What's Going on in Belarus?" (*Munk School of Global Affairs and Public Policy, University of Toronto, June 2021*)

Conference and Workshop Presentations

2026 Russia Seminar (National Defense University of Finland)
2025 International Council for Central and East European Studies World Convention
2024 Aleksanteri Conference (University of Helsinki); European Political Science Association Annual Convention
2023 Aleksanteri Conference (University of Helsinki)
2022 Association for the Study of Nationalities World Convention

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Helsinki

REE-553: Making Sense of Russia's War in Ukraine, Instructor *September 2025 – ongoing*
REE-524: Comparative Authoritarianism in Central and Eastern Europe, Instructor *September 2025 – December 2025*

University of Toronto

TRN250: Ordering International Relations in an Age of Empire, Teaching Assistant *September 2021 – May 2024*
POL354: Russian Politics, Teaching Assistant *January 2024 – May 2025*
POL324: European Union: Politics, Institutions and Society, Teaching Assistant *January 2024 – May 2024*
POL208: Introduction to International Relations, Teaching Assistant *September 2023 – December 2023*
POL101: The Real World of Politics: An Introduction, Teaching Assistant *September 2022 – May 2023*

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Doctoral Fellowship, Social Science & Humanities Research Council (Canada) *2025 - 2027*
Dr Roman Turko and Yaroslawa Turko Scholarship in Ukrainian Studies, University of Toronto *2024*
Dmytro and Natalia Haluszka Family Scholarship in Ukrainian Studies, University of Toronto *2023, 2024*
Department of Political Science Graduate Program Recruitment Award, University of Toronto *2022*
Domestic Graduate Entrance Award, University of Toronto *2022*

SERVICE

Conferences

Panel Discussant, APSA (2025); EPSA (2024)
Panel Chair, Aleksanteri Conference (2024)

Manuscript Reviewing

Problems of Post Communism

University of Helsinki

Co-Chair, Ukraine Study Group (2024 - ongoing)
Organizer and Panel Chair (Security), Roundtable on the Russian Invasion of Ukraine (2025, 2026)

University of Toronto

Co-chair, Comparative Autocracy Research Cluster, University of Toronto (2022 – 2024)
Treasurer, Graduate Association of Students in Political Science, University of Toronto (2023)

MISCELLANEOUS

Additional Training

Bellingcat Open-Source Intelligence Training (RuNET)

Programming

R; L^AT_EX

Languages

English (*native*); Russian (*native*); Ukrainian (*full professional proficiency*); French (*full professional proficiency*);
Belarusian (*reading knowledge*)